

Claire Groves, Ph.D.

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Professional summary

Ph.D. in Psychology specializing in physical activity epidemiology, longitudinal data analysis, mental health and wearable-sensor research. Expert in compositional data analysis, structural equation modeling, and growth-curve modeling using R, Mplus, and SPSS. Proven record of analyzing data with 10,000+ participants and translating findings into six peer-reviewed publications and 20+ conference presentations. Proficient at open-science workflows, IRB compliance, and cross-functional collaboration to drive evidence-based health policy.

Education

Ph.D., Psychology, The University of Texas at San Antonio

Dissertation: Bidirectional Associations Between Movement Behaviors and Internalizing Symptoms in Adolescents: A Cross-Lagged Panel Model with Compositional Data Analysis

M.A., Psychological Sciences, Northern Arizona University, *with distinction GPA: 4.0*

B.A., Psychology, Coker University, *summa cum laude GPA: 4.0*

Experience

Graduate Researcher

The University of Texas at San Antonio

San Antonio, TX

July 2022 – June, 2025

- Headed 5 + research projects on the impact of physical activity on health using compositional data analysis and structural equation modeling
- Managed datasets with 10,000 + participants, including device-measured activity data, and implemented advanced statistical analyses in RStudio
- Designed, executed, and published 3 + systematic reviews and 3 + empirical studies in peer-reviewed journals
- Collaborated across interdisciplinary teams and contributed to grant-funded research initiatives
- Coordinated IRB submissions across three study waves and supervised a team of five research assistants, achieving on-time project milestones

Research Assistant

Northern Arizona University

Flagstaff, AZ

August 2020 – May 2022

- Modeled associations among stress, resilience, and physical activity in 500 college students using mixed-effects and mediation analyses; findings presented at national conferences
- Trained and supervised eight undergraduate researchers in study protocol, R programming, and manuscript preparation

Teaching Assistant

Northern Arizona University

Flagstaff, AZ

August 2020 – May 2022

- Delivered 15+ guest lectures on research methods, statistics, and cognitive psychology to classes of up to 60 students, earning average teaching evaluations of 4.8/5
- Provided weekly office hours and individualized feedback, boosting student competency in statistical analyses and research methods

Publications & Presentations

- Six peer-reviewed journal articles (two first-author); full list available upon request
- Five oral and 19 poster presentations at national and international conferences

Awards & Honors

- Student Research Award, Society of Behavioral Medicine Physical Activity SIG (2025)
- UTSA Graduate School, College of Health, and Psychology Department Travel Awards (2022-2025)
- People's Choice Award Winner, Northern Arizona University Research Symposium

Skills & Competencies

Quantitative Methods | Statistical Modeling | Data Visualization | Rstudio | SPSS | Mplus | Handling Large Datasets | Missing Data Analysis | Open Science Practices | IRB Processes | Scientific Writing | Grant Writing | Conference Presentations | Cross-Functional Collaboration | Multi-Project Coordination | Workflow Optimization | Remote Collaboration